Lead Broker Blueprint by Lorenzo Marietti

Module 2 deliverable

Niche Evaluation Worksheet

Score yourself; score the verticals; produce a defensible short list

How to use this worksheet

This worksheet is meant to be filled in — printed and written by hand, or filled using a PDF reader's text/typewriter annotation tool. There are four parts:

1. **Self-assessment** — score your own situation across six dimensions.
2. **Candidate verticals** — score 2–4 verticals you're considering, against the six-factor framework from Lesson 2.1.
3. **Short list** — pick 1–2 verticals you can defend choosing.
4. **Validation plan** — design a $500–2,000 experiment to test the short-list winner before committing.

Use the Vertical Comparison spreadsheet (delivered with this module) as a starting reference for the framework scores, then override based on your own research.

Part 1 — Self-assessment

Score yourself honestly across six dimensions. These determine which verticals will be accessible to you and which will be uphill.

Capital available to invest in this business

Total dollars you can commit before needing the business to generate revenue. Be honest — if you'd like the number to be higher, that's a different sentence than what the number actually is.

Amount (USD) _____

Bucket:

☐ Under $5k ☐ $5k–$15k ☐ $15k–$50k ☐ Over $50k

Time available per week

Hours per week you can realistically commit, sustained over 6+ months.

☐ Under 10 hrs/wk ☐ 10–25 hrs/wk ☐ 25–40 hrs/wk ☐ Full-time (40+)

Relevant skills

Check all that apply.

☐ Paid search (Google/Bing Ads experience)

☐ Paid social (Meta/TikTok/LinkedIn Ads experience)

☐ SEO and content marketing

☐ Outbound B2B (email, LinkedIn, calling)

☐ Sales and account management

☐ Technical (CRM admin, lead routing platforms, scripting)

☐ Domain expertise in a specific vertical (specify):

Vertical: _____

Network in any specific vertical

Existing relationships you could leverage for first 2–3 buyer contracts. Even one or two warm contacts in a vertical is meaningful.

Vertical(s) where you have relationships:

Estimated number of warm contacts:

Count _____

Geographic flexibility

Are you focused on a single metro/region, or can you sell into any U.S. market? Local-services and many home-services niches reward geographic focus; insurance and B2B are more national.

☐ Tied to a specific metro ☐ State-level focus ☐ Regional (multi-state) ☐ National flexibility

Licensure willingness

Some verticals require professional licensing (insurance, NMLS for mortgage). If you're unwilling to obtain licensure, those verticals are effectively closed without a licensed partner.

☐ Willing to obtain insurance license ☐ Willing to obtain NMLS license ☐ Not willing to pursue licensure

Part 2 — Candidate verticals

Score 2–4 verticals you're seriously considering against the six-factor framework from Lesson 2.1. Use the Vertical Comparison spreadsheet as a reference but override scores based on your own knowledge of the vertical.

Scoring scale: 5 = favorable for newcomer / low friction; 1 = unfavorable / high friction.

Candidate 1

Vertical / sub-vertical: _____

Factor	Your score (1–5)	One-line justification
Demand stability		
Lead price ceiling		
Competition level		
Regulatory complexity		
Beginner accessibility		
Capital required		
TOTAL (sum of six)		(out of 30 — pattern matters as much as total)

Why this vertical might fit your situation (2–3 sentences):

Candidate 2

Vertical / sub-vertical: _____

Factor	Your score (1–5)	One-line justification
Demand stability		
Lead price ceiling		
Competition level		
Regulatory complexity		
Beginner accessibility		
Capital required		
TOTAL (sum of six)		(out of 30 — pattern matters as much as total)

Why this vertical might fit your situation (2–3 sentences):

Candidate 3

Vertical / sub-vertical: _____

Factor	Your score (1–5)	One-line justification
Demand stability		
Lead price ceiling		
Competition level		
Regulatory complexity		
Beginner accessibility		
Capital required		
TOTAL (sum of six)		(out of 30 — pattern matters as much as total)

Why this vertical might fit your situation (2–3 sentences):

Candidate 4

Vertical / sub-vertical: _____

Factor	Your score (1–5)	One-line justification
Demand stability		
Lead price ceiling		
Competition level		
Regulatory complexity		
Beginner accessibility		
Capital required		
TOTAL (sum of six)		(out of 30 — pattern matters as much as total)

Why this vertical might fit your situation (2–3 sentences):

Part 3 — Short list

From the candidates above, choose 1–2 that you can defend in writing. "Defend" means: if a thoughtful friend asks you why this vertical and not the others, you can give a coherent answer that addresses your capital, time, skills, network, and risk tolerance.

Primary short-list vertical

Vertical: _____

Why this one, in three sentences:

What you give up by choosing this one:

Secondary short-list vertical (optional)

Vertical: _____

Why this one as a backup:

Part 4 — Validation plan

Before committing to the primary short-list vertical for a full year, run a small experiment to test your core assumptions. Target budget: $500–$2,000. Target duration: 30–60 days.

Hypothesis you're testing

Example: "At $X per lead, I can produce HVAC leads in [my metro] that contractors will pay $Y for at a rate that supports a workable margin."

Budget

Total budget (USD) _____

Ad spend portion _____

Tooling / one-time costs _____

Timeline

Start date _____

Decision date (when you'll evaluate) _____

What you'll measure

Examples: cost per lead, lead-to-buyer-acceptance rate, buyer feedback on lead quality, paid-channel CPC trends.

Decision rule

Specifically: what would make you commit to this vertical for a year? What would make you walk away? Write this BEFORE you start the experiment — not after.

If [specific result], I commit:

If [specific result], I move to the secondary vertical or stop:

Buyer-side conversations

Before spending on traffic, talk to 5–10 prospective buyers in your short-list vertical. Names and dates:

Final reflection

Three short questions to answer once you've completed the worksheet.

1. What surprised you about the scoring exercise?

2. What's the biggest risk you're knowingly taking on by choosing this vertical?

3. What's your honest off-ramp — the moment at which you'd quit this vertical and try something different?

Standing disclosures

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